

Leverage Board · Notre Dame

2026 season · data Sep 3 · AP wk 1 · SP+ 2026 · 75% to make the 12-team field · proj. 10.3–1.7 · 30,000 simulated seasons

Team	AP	CFP	Playoff	Wk 1	Wk 2	Wk 3	Wk 4	Wk 5	Wk 6	Wk 7	Wk 8	Wk 9	Wk 10	Wk 11	Wk 12	Wk 13
Notre Dame	4	NR	75%	Wisc 92%	Rice 100%	Mich St 95%	@Purdue 95%	@UNC 90%	Stanford 97%	@BYU 72%	bye	@Navy 94%	Miami 68%	BC 97%	SMU 84%	@Syracuse 94%
Ohio St	1	NR	80%	Ball St 100%	@Texas 68%	Kent St 100%	Illinois 93%	@Iowa 83%	Maryland 96%	@Indiana 61%	bye	@USC 78%	Oregon 64%	NWern 96%	@Nebraska 90%	Michigan 86%
Oregon	2	NR	72%	Boise St 94%	@Okla St 89%	Portland 100%	@USC 71%	bye	UCLA 94%	Nebraska 91%	@Illinois 84%	NWern 94%	@Ohio St 36%	Michigan 81%	@Mich St 93%	Wash 83%
Georgia	3	NR	61%	Tenn St 100%	W Kentucky 99%	@Arkansas 87%	Okla 72%	Vandy 87%	@Alabama 66%	Auburn 85%	bye	Florida 75%	@Ole Miss 79%	Missouri 76%	@S Car 76%	Ga Tech 92%
Texas	5	NR	37%	Texas St 95%	Ohio St 32%	UTSA 94%	@Tenn 58%	bye	@Okla 60%	Florida 72%	Ole Miss 70%	Miss St 89%	@Missouri 62%	@LSU 50%	Arkansas 88%	@Tex A&M 49%
Indiana	6	NR	63%	N Texas 99%	Howard 100%	W Kentucky 99%	NWern 92%	@Rutgers 90%	@Nebraska 81%	Ohio St 39%	@Michigan 66%	Minn 91%	bye	USC 73%	@Wash 68%	Purdue 97%
Miami	7	NR	60%	@Stanford 91%	FAMU 100%	@Wake 84%	C Mich 99%	@Clemson 66%	bye	Fla St 82%	Pitt 86%	@UNC 84%	@N Dame 34%	Duke 87%	Va Tech 83%	BC 95%
Texas A&M	8	NR	33%	Mo State 99%	Ariz St 86%	Kentucky 86%	@LSU 46%	Arkansas 86%	@Missouri 58%	Citadel 100%	@Alabama 53%	bye	@S Car 64%	Tenn 64%	@Okla 50%	Texas 51%
Ole Miss	9	NR	17%	L'ville 63%	Charlotte 100%	LSU 46%	@Florida 48%	bye	@Vandy 61%	Missouri 58%	@Texas 30%	Auburn 67%	Georgia 32%	@Okla 39%	Wofford 100%	Miss St 80%
Oklahoma	10	NR	23%	UTEP 99%	@Michigan 49%	N Mexico 90%	@Georgia 28%	bye	Texas 40%	Kentucky 83%	@Miss St 76%	S Car 69%	@Florida 53%	Ole Miss 61%	Tex A&M 50%	@Missouri 53%
LSU	11	NR	33%	Clemson 72%	La Tech 97%	@Ole Miss 54%	Tex A&M 54%	McNeese 100%	@Kentucky 78%	Miss St 86%	@Auburn 66%	bye	Alabama 62%	Texas 50%	@Tenn 52%	@Arkansas 78%
Texas Tech	12	NR	63%	Ablene 100%	@Ore St 94%	Houston 84%	Sam Hou 100%	@Colorado 87%	bye	Ariz St 88%	@Cincy 84%	Arizona 81%	WVU 94%	@Okla St 78%	@Baylor 83%	TCU 81%
Alabama	13	NR	22%	ECU 91%	@Kentucky 73%	Fla St 74%	S Car 67%	@Miss St 74%	Georgia 34%	@Tenn 45%	Tex A&M 47%	bye	@LSU 38%	@Vandy 63%	Chatt 100%	Auburn 69%
BYU	14	NR	29%	Utah Tech 100%	Arizona 68%	@Colo St 93%	bye	@TCU 86%	Iowa St 86%	N Dame 28%	@UCF 75%	Ariz St 77%	@Utah 57%	Baylor 79%	@Kansas 72%	Cincy 80%
USC	14	NR	23%	Fresno St 90%	Louisiana 97%	@Rutgers 78%	Oregon 29%	Wash 60%	@Penn St 48%	bye	@Wisc 76%	Ohio St 22%	bye	@Indiana 27%	Maryland 81%	@UCLA 73%
Michigan	16	NR	19%	W Mich 94%	Okla 51%	UTEP 99%	Iowa 61%	@Minn 70%	bye	Penn St 57%	Indiana 34%	@Rutgers 77%	Mich St 85%	@Oregon 19%	UCLA 80%	@Ohio St 14%
Wash	17	NR	19%	Wash St 91%	Utah St 94%	E Wash 100%	Minn 76%	@USC 40%	Iowa 58%	@Purdue 83%	bye	@Nebraska 60%	Penn St 54%	@Mich St 76%	Indiana 32%	@Oregon 17%
Penn St	18	NR	28%	Marshall 95%	@Temple 92%	Buffalo 97%	Wisc 81%	@NWern 71%	USC 52%	@Michigan 43%	bye	Purdue 89%	@Wash 46%	Minn 77%	Rutgers 83%	@Maryland 70%
SMU	19	NR	21%	@Fla St 52%	UC Davis 100%	@L'ville 47%	Mo State 98%	BC 85%	bye	Virginia 65%	Cal 75%	@Syracuse 76%	Va Tech 64%	Wake 75%	@N Dame 16%	@Stanford 77%
Tennessee	20	NR	22%	Furman 100%	@Ga Tech 71%	Kennesaw 98%	Texas 42%	Auburn 69%	@Arkansas 72%	Alabama 55%	@S Car 56%	bye	Kentucky 81%	@Tex A&M 36%	LSU 48%	@Vandy 63%
Utah	21	NR	14%	Idaho 100%	Arkansas 65%	Utah St 89%	@Iowa St 69%	bye	Kansas 70%	@Colorado 66%	Houston 61%	@Cincy 61%	BYU 43%	@Arizona 45%	@TCU 46%	WVU 79%
Iowa	22	NR	17%	NIU 98%	Iowa St 85%	N Iowa 100%	@Michigan 39%	Ohio St 17%	@Wash 42%	bye	@Minn 65%	Wisc 78%	@NWern 67%	Purdue 55%	@Illinois 55%	Nebraska 68%
Houston	23	NR	9%	Ore St 82%	Southern 100%	@Tex Tech 16%	@Ga So 83%	UCF 68%	@K-State 40%	Okla St 56%	@Utah 39%	bye	Cincy 66%	@Colorado 61%	@WVU 65%	Baylor 64%
Louisville	24	NR	17%	@Ole Miss 37%	Villanova 100%	SMU 53%	Wake 73%	@NC State 58%	Fla St 60%	@Syracuse 74%	bye	Stanford 83%	@Ga Tech 57%	@UNC 63%	Pitt 67%	@Kentucky 59%
Missouri	25	NR	15%	Ark-PB 100%	@Kansas 73%	Troy 94%	@Miss St 69%	Florida 56%	Tex A&M 42%	@Ole Miss 42%	bye	@Arkansas 68%	Texas 38%	@Georgia 21%	Kentucky 77%	Okla 47%

How to read this

- You want this team to win
- You want this team to lose
- Head-to-head with Notre Dame

"@" = on the road · % = their chance of winning (SP+)
Notre Dame's own row is shaded by each game's leverage on its own schedule; the Playoff column by playoff chance.

WHAT THE SHADING MEANS

Darker means the game matters more to Notre Dame: it weighs how much the result would move Notre Dame's playoff odds together with how likely that swing is, so a coin flip between two contenders shows up stronger than a near-certain blowout. A game can matter because the loser drops behind you in the rankings, because a conference title and its automatic bid change hands, or because a team on your schedule ends up with a better or worse record.

Every shade comes from playing out the rest of the season 30,000 times and flipping each game one at a time to see whether Notre Dame still makes the field.

BIGGEST GAMES NOT INVOLVING NOTRE DAME

- Wk 5: Miami at Clemson — pull for **Miami**
- Wk 12: Memphis at Navy — pull for **Navy**
- Wk 10: BYU at Utah — pull for **BYU**
- Wk 8: USC at Wisconsin — pull for **Wisconsin**
- Wk 2: Arizona at BYU — pull for **BYU**
- Wk 3: SMU at Louisville — pull for **SMU**

Field = ACC, Big Ten, Big 12 and SEC champions plus the highest-ranked Group of Six champion, then the seven highest-ranked teams remaining; straight seeding. Win probabilities from the SP+ rating gap with home advantage; final ordering is a strength-plus-résumé stand-in for the committee.